

RATINGS

G2 Rating 4.6 / 5 42 reviews	Capterra 4.6 / 5 52 reviews
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PRICING MODEL

Entry price (GBP)	£79/mo
Entry price (AUD)	N/A – GAP
Billing	Per user/month
Annual discount	Yes
Starter includes	5 users
Overage policy	Per extra user

FREE TRIAL

Free trial	14 days
Credit card req.	No
Demo available	Yes

LIGHTYEAR VS ZAHARA — FEATURE COMPARISON

FEATURE	LIGHTYEAR	ZAHARA
Invoice capture	AI + OCR	Via Xero/Sage
Budget control	No	Yes
PO creation	Yes	Yes
3-way matching	Line-level	Basic
Price checking	Automated	No
Statement recon	Automated	No
Fraud detection	Bank details	No
Approval levels	Up to 8	Up to 5
Free trial	30 days	14 days
Storage	7 years	7 years

LIGHTYEAR WINS WHEN...

- Invoice capture is a requirement (Zahara has none)
- Price checking against supplier contracts
- Statement reconciliation automation
- Fraud prevention on bank detail changes

WHY LIGHTYEAR — KEY DIFFERENCES

After You've Committed

Zahara controls your budget before you spend. Lightyear controls what suppliers charge after you've committed — verifying every invoice against agreed prices.

Invoice Capture Included

Lightyear includes AI-powered invoice capture. Zahara relies on Xero or Sage for capture — an additional dependency and cost.

Statement Reconciliation

Lightyear automates supplier statement reconciliation natively. Zahara has no statement reconciliation capability.

Fraud Prevention

Lightyear flags bank detail changes on invoices against your records. Zahara has no bank detail fraud detection.

More Approval Levels

Lightyear supports up to 8 approval tiers. Zahara supports up to 5 — a real limitation for complex multi-entity approval hierarchies.

VS ZAHARA

ABOUT LIGHTYEAR

Lightyear is an AP automation platform built for businesses that want complete control over supplier invoices — from automated price checking and PO matching to multi-tier approvals and statement reconciliation. Part of The Access Group.

Start a free trial →

ABOUT ZAHARA

UK-based purchase-to-pay platform with budget management and approval workflows. Strong nominal coding and multi-entity support. GBP pricing published on site. No native invoice capture — integrates with Xero and Sage.

LIGHTYEAR WINS WHEN...

- Invoice capture is a requirement (Zahara has none)
- Price checking against supplier contracts
- Statement reconciliation automation
- Fraud prevention on bank detail changes
- Longer free trial for evaluation